

SKOAR!

MASS EFFECT 3



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Hugely popular in its previous two installments, BioWare's sci-fi trilogy reaches an epic and memorable conclusion in this thriller, action-packed game. Mass Effect 3 is bigger, better, more gripping than any previous episode of the celebrated RPG franchise. Choice, morality and doing things for the greater good are pivotal themes in the emotional ride that is Mass Effect 3.

Mass Effect 3 begins with you reprising the role of Commander Jack Shepard. The Reapers aren't just a dreadful monster in a forgotten childhood nightmare, these things actually exist. And they're back to point a super-cool weapon at you and everything that con-

nects you with a microbe in the neighboring galaxy, and zap the living daylights out of all organic lifeforms.

You don't mess with the Reapers, but that's exactly what Commander Jack Shepard must do in Mass Effect 3, as he travels through the galaxy to build an allied force to combat the far-superior death squads of

Reapers popping up all over the place. This is easier said than done, for Mass Effect 3 brilliantly interweaves the elements of RPG into the overall combat, war-like mood and pace of the game – Shepard has to rely on his weapons as well as his tongue to broker peace and win over opposing forces to have any chance of challenging the bad guys. If you're a hardcore RPG fan, deriving a game's high points from dialogue and character building, you'll enjoy Shepard's quest to win support among all aliens and unite them against their existential danger.

Mass Effect 2 was a big jump from the original Mass Effect, in terms of gameplay mechanics. While Mass Effect 3 isn't as quantum a leap from the overall gameplay experience as Mass Effect 2, it still tweaks the engine and refines the tools of the trade to heighten the overall end-user experience. The words you speak or actions you perform can take the storyline on a whole different tangent. Mass Effect 3 leaves you with endless possibilities to reach the end goal – a trait that's unique and rare in modern games. It's also something that's difficult to pull off successfully in game design.

BioWare hasn't touched what worked wonderfully well in Mass Effect 2, but has fixed elements that needed minor tweaks. Commander Shepard's movements have been slightly altered; he's a lot more fluid and agile in Mass Effect 3 compared to Mass Effect 2. There are plenty of missions aside from the main

storyline to keep you engrossed. However, the side missions or quests aren't as interesting as in the previous two games. But this is a minor kink. Levels are greater in depth than ever before and carefully sculpted. The graphics and art feel of the overall game is nothing short of exceptional. Mass Effect 3 continues to provide excellent voice overs for all its characters – no two voices sound the same and this heightens the experience of the game. *

Verdict

Mass Effect 3 successfully delivers a gripping, never-before-seen trilogy with a powerful interconnecting story. It's like being in Battlestar Galactica or Star Trek, with you playing the lead character and shaping his or her destiny the way you want. It's the highest compliment we can pay to Mass Effect 3. It truly is an experience you'll remember for days to come.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** BioWare
- » **Publisher:** Electronic Arts
- » **Genre:** Action RPG
- » **Price:** ₹2,799 (PS3), ₹2,799 (Xbox 360), ₹1,299 (PC)

